

Module 4: Web Application Security



Topic 5: PHP Basics



What is PHP?

- PHP is one of the most common scripting languages used in web development, more than 70% of websites use it.
- Abbreviation for “Hypertext preprocessor”
- Widely used, open source scripting language that runs and executes on server side. It free to download and use anywhere.
- PHP can:
 - Generate dynamic page contents
 - Create, open, read, write and delete files on the server
 - Can add, delete and modify data in database
 - Can be used to encrypt data
- PHP is compatible with all servers (Apache, IIS,..etc.) & with all platforms (windows, Linux, Mac, ..etc.)
- PHP scripts extension is .php

PHP Variables and Functions

Variables:

- User defined variables

```
1  $str_variable = "This is my text";  
2  $numeric_variable = 1;  
3  $boolean_variable = True;  
4
```

- Built-in variables (reserved variables that can be accessed from anywhere)

`$GLOBALS` , `$_SERVER`, `$_REQUEST`, `$_POST`, `$_GET`, `$_FILES`, `$_ENV`,
`$_COOKIE`, `$_SESSION`

- PHP variables are case sensitive

PHB Variables and Functions

Functions

Functions also are: User-defined functions & built-in functions

- User-defined functions

```
1 function welcomeMsg() {  
2     echo "Welcome!";  
3 }
```

```
1 welcomeMsg();
```

- Built-in functions

Functions that are used to perform known tasks like getting date, setting time, handling errors, etc.